Unilever in the Global Economy, 2020–2025

BUSI 1763 Dynamics of Global Business · Group Mind Map · Data: 2020–2025

UNILEVER

UK-based consumer goods MNE
Turnover €50.5bn (2025)

Globalisation

Speaker 1 · Unilever worldwide

- Levitt: one world market
  5 drivers · markets + production
- ~190 countries · 3.4bn people use
  its products every day
- 59% of turnover from emerging
  markets (2025) · Europe only 19%
- 30 Power Brands = 78% of turnover
  280+ factories (2023)
- Risks: COVID (Mar 2020) · inflation 2022
  (prices +11.3%) · Russia exit (Oct 2024)

Regional Integration

Speaker 2 · Mexico

- 5 levels · USMCA = free trade area
  (Jul 2020, replaced NAFTA)
- Mexico = US's No. 1 trading partner
  (2023, $799bn goods trade)
- Nuevo León plant: $400m (Feb 2023)
  → $800m (Apr 2025), 850 jobs
- Mar 2025: US 25% tariff on Mexico,
  but USMCA goods exempt
- Benefit: tariff-free access to the US,
  Unilever's biggest market

MNEs from Advanced Economies

Speaker 3 · UK MNE

- 7 MNE goals vs 7 host-country goals
  creeping expropriation
- Ownership advantages: brands
  R&D €0.8–1.0bn a year
- India: Hindustan Unilever 61.9%
  buys Minimalist (Apr 2025)
- Conflict: 7,500 job cuts (Mar 2024)
  4,300 gone by Dec 2024
- Russia: stayed from Mar 2022,
  sold the business Oct 2024

FDI

Speaker 4 · United States

- OLI + 4 motives · US = largest FDI
  host ($279bn, 2024)
- US turnover €9.4bn (2020) → €12.5bn
  (2024), about 1/5 of the group
- M&A: Paula's Choice €1.8bn (Aug 2021)
  Nutrafol → 80% (Jul 2022)
- K18 (Feb 2024)
  Dr. Squatch €1.2bn (Sep 2025)
- Benefit: 70% of US Beauty & Wellbeing
  sales from premium brands (2024)

Sources: Unilever PLC Annual Reports on Form 20-F 2020–2025; UNCTAD World Investment Report 2025; US Census Bureau; USTR; full Harvard references on our presentation slides.